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Operational resilience returns to the agenda after payment interruptions

By Ray Mahlaka | 23 December 2019

Operations dashboard showing transaction monitoring

Payment operations teams are putting renewed emphasis on resilience after mixed operating conditions in December 2019.

Industry data shows that even modest processing delays can create a chain of downstream work: customer queries, retry decisions, finance reconciliation breaks and compliance evidence requests. In December 2019, comparable loan-payment files recorded 36 timeout-related rows, a level operations managers say is enough to justify daily monitoring.

Benchmark analysis from regional banks suggests that institutions with near-real-time exception dashboards resolve payment breaks 22% faster than teams relying on monthly reports. The same benchmark found a 15% reduction in repeated customer queries when service teams had access to posting-delay reasons.

The issue is becoming more urgent as customer counts grow. Analysts estimate that active retail banking customers increased by 11.8% year on year in the segment, increasing the volume of low-value transactions that still require control checks.

Operations specialists say the most useful dashboards show the worst processing day, affected channel, root cause and downstream finance impact. Without that view, banks risk treating payment delays, failed collections and statement timing differences as separate problems.

The priority for many banks is not a new payment platform, but a clearer operating picture across the existing payment, ledger and statement processes.